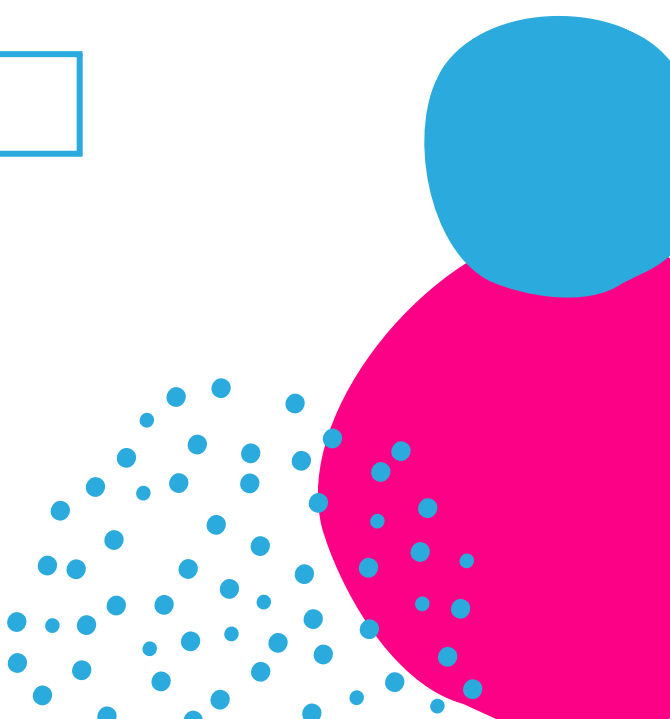


COMPARE AND CONTRAST IN IELTS SPEAKING

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Helping you Become a Confident English Speaker

Many IELTS students lack confidence in their speaking skills.

The Keith Speaking Academy helps you develop your speaking skills so you can face the examiner with confidence and ace the IELTS test.

This PDF is one of many that Keith has developed to help you do this.



Keith has been working in international education for over 20 years as a teacher, teacher trainer, and education manager.

He has helped over 40,000 students prepare for their IELTS Speaking test with his online courses.

A key skill you need to use in IELTS Speaking is how to **compare and contrast** things, people, places, activities and general ideas.

In [IELTS Speaking Part 1](#), you may be asked directly the difference between A and B (e.g. between living in the city and living in the countryside).

In [IELTS Speaking Part 3](#), you will need to compare and contrast more abstract ideas, opinions and examples.

In this PDF, I will give you the language you need to do that confidently.



Comparing and contrasting

What do we mean by comparing and contrasting?

- **Comparing** generally means finding the **similarities**.
- **Contrasting** generally means finding the **differences**.

Comparing places, people, activities and things

The simplest way to find similarities is as follows:

- **A is similar to B**
- **A is similar to B because**
- **A is similar to B in that....**

If we are talking about places,

- **London is similar to Paris because they are both capital cities**
- **London is similar to Paris in that they have similar populations**

We can also show the level of similarity and make our answers richer by using adverbs, such as

- really
- pretty
- rather
- quite

For example,

- **London is pretty similar to Paris in that they have similar populations**

Another way to express **similarity** is to mention both of them first and then give a **summarising phrase**.

If we are comparing cars or brands, we can say the following:

- **When it comes to cars, two of the most famous brands are Audi and BMW, they are so alike**

We can also use:

- **They are pretty much alike**
- **They have a lot in common**
- **They are really similar**

In addition, we can show likeness with this structure to

- **A is as _____ as B**

For example,

- **An Audi is as reliable as a BMW**
- **Paris is (almost) as big as London**
- **John is as tall as Michael**



Finally, if two things or people are actually the same, we can say,

- **A is identical to B**
- **A is the same as B**

If we are talking about people, for example,

- Jack is **identical to** his father, both of them love football
- Jack is **the same as** his father, they both love football

Other common phrases are;

- Jack is **just like** his father
- Jack is **the spitting image of** his father

This last phrase refers to physical appearance only.

Contrasting places, people, activities and things

The simplest way to find differences is as follows:

- **A is different from B**
- **A is different from B because**
- **A is different from B in that it**

For example,

- **Manchester is different from Paris**
- **Manchester is different from Paris because it is much more industrial**
- **Manchester is different from Paris in that the climate is colder (than Paris).**

Remember, we can also express the size of the difference with adverbs, such as,

- **It is is totally different**
- **I think it's strikingly different**
- **It's distinctly different**

If the difference is slight;

- **it's slightly different**
- **it's rather different**
- **it's subtly different**

Idiomatic expressions for contrasting

Here are some idiomatic expressions we can use to express contrasts, especially big differences.

1. They are worlds apart

- Manchester United and Real Madrid **are world's apart**. Manchester United is a much better team 😊

2. They are poles apart

- Manchester and London **are poles apart**, I mean they really have almost nothing in common.

3. A is a far cry from B

- This museum **is a far cry from** what I imagined. I thought it would be rubbish, but it's actually great.

4. A is in a different league from B

- My maths teacher is great, he **is in a different league** compared to all the other teachers.

5. A is far/way ____ than B

- Beijing is **far bigger** than Manchester
- Hong Kong is **way hotter than** Manchester.

Connectors to compare and contrast ideas

Here are some connectors you can use to compare and contrast ideas, as well as things.

- **Similarly**
- **Likewise**

- I love football, **similarly**, I am big fan of basketball too.
- I love Chinese food, **likewise**, I'm really into Vietnamese food as well.

- **On the contrary**
- **Conversely**
- **On the other hand**

- I am really busy during the week, but on the weekend, **conversely**, I have lots of free time

Notice in speaking, the word order is a little different from writing:
__ noun 1, noun 2 + adverb, ____

- I'm really busy on Mondays, Fridays, **on the contrary**, are much easier.
- I'm busy this week, next week, **on the other hand**, I have much less work to do.

That's it.

Interesting and beautiful ways to compare and contrast places, things, people ideas... in fact anything you like.



Find out more information about IELTS Speaking here:

WWW.KEITHSPEAKINGACADEMY.COM

